SALES LESSON PLAN 06 / SOURCE MATERIAL

Handling Objections

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Level: B1
Duration: 60 minutes
Topic: Vocabulary for Handling Objections
Main objective: By the end of the lesson, the student will be able to understand and use common vocabulary and expressions for identifying, acknowledging, clarifying, and responding to customer objections during a sales conversation.

1. Lead-in - What Is a Sales Objection?

5-10 minutes

Start by asking the student what happens when a customer is interested in a product but doesn't want to buy it immediately.

The teacher asks:

What is a sales objection?

Why might a customer say no to a product?

What are some common objections in sales?

What can a customer say if they think something is too expensive?

What can a customer say if they don't need the product?

What can a customer say if they need more time?

How should a salesperson respond to an objection?

Should a salesperson argue with the customer?

Quick brainstorm

Write:

CUSTOMER OBJECTIONS

Then create four categories:

PRICE | NEED | TIMING | TRUST

Ask the student to think of possible objections for each category.

For example:

PRICE

"It's too expensive."

NEED

"We don't really need this."

TIMING

"We're not ready to buy yet."

TRUST

"I'd like to know more about your company first."

2. Warm-up - What Would You Say?

5 minutes

Read the following customer statements.

Ask the student:

What would you say as a salesperson?

Customer A

"Your product looks good, but it's too expensive for us."

Customer B

"We already have a system that works."

Customer C

"We need to think about it."

Customer D

"I'm not sure this solution is right for our company."

Customer E

"Now isn't a good time for us."

Don't correct the student's language yet.

The objective is to activate their existing vocabulary and identify what they already know about handling objections.

3. Vocabulary Presentation - The Language of Objections

15 minutes

A. Common Sales Objections

Vocabulary

Meaning

objection

a reason for not buying something

concern

something that makes the customer worried

hesitation

uncertainty about making a decision

doubt

a feeling of uncertainty

issue

a problem or difficulty

reason

an explanation for a decision

budget

the amount of money available

priority

something that is especially important

timing

whether the moment is right

alternative

another possible choice

Examples

The customer has an objection about the price.

I understand your concern.

The customer's main issue is the cost.

They have some doubts about changing providers.

B. Identifying Different Types of Objections

Price Objections

Customers may say:

It's too expensive.

It's outside our budget.

We can't afford it right now.

Your price is higher than your competitors'.

Useful vocabulary:

price

cost

budget

affordable

expensive

value

investment

Product / Need Objections

Customers may say:

We don't need it.

Our current system works well.

We already have a similar solution.

I'm not sure this would help us.

Useful vocabulary:

need

solution

current system

alternative

benefit

value

requirement

C. Timing Objections

Customers may say:

We're not ready yet.

Now isn't a good time.

We need more time.

Maybe next year.

Useful vocabulary:

timing

deadline

schedule

priority

ready

delay

later

Decision-Making Objections

Customers may say:

I need to speak to my manager.

I need to discuss it with my team.

I'm not the final decision-maker.

We need to compare some other options.

Useful vocabulary:

decision-maker

stakeholder

approval

decision

option

compare

evaluate

Vocabulary for Responding to Objections

The most important thing is that the salesperson doesn't immediately try to argue with the customer.

The conversation can follow this structure:

1. Acknowledge

I understand your concern.

That's a good point.

I understand where you're coming from.

I see what you mean.

2. Clarify

Could you tell me a little more about that?

What specifically concerns you?

Could you explain what you mean?

Is the main concern the price?

3. Respond

That's understandable.

Let me explain how it works.

One thing to consider is...

The main benefit is...

We may have another option.

4. Check

Does that answer your question?

Would that address your concern?

How does that sound?

Would that work for you?

5. Move forward

Would you like me to show you...?

Shall we look at another option?

Would it make sense to discuss this with your team?

Would you like to schedule another call?

6. Vocabulary Practice - Match the Objection

10-15 minutes

Match each customer statement with the type of objection.

Types:

A. Price
B. Need
C. Timing
D. Decision-making

___ "We need to speak to our CEO first."

___ "It's outside our budget."

___ "We're happy with our current software."

___ "We're not ready to make a decision yet."

___ "I need to compare your product with another option."

___ "We don't really need this right now."

___ "Your competitors are cheaper."

___ "I'd like to discuss this with my team first."

7. Complete the Responses

Choose the best expression.

I understand your concern.
Could you tell me more about that?
That's a good point.
Let me explain.
Would that work for you?
One thing to consider is...

1.

Customer:

"I'm worried about the implementation time."

Salesperson:

2.

Customer:

"Your software is more expensive than the other option."

Salesperson:

3.

Customer:

"I'm not sure the product will work for our team."

Salesperson:

4.

Customer:

"We need to talk to our CEO first."

Salesperson:

5.

Customer:

"I don't understand why we need to change our current system."

Salesperson:

8. Reading-Handling a Customer Objection

15-20 minutes

The Price Objection

Emma is a sales executive at TechSolutions. She has just presented a software solution to David, the operations director of a logistics company.

During the discovery call, David explained that his company wanted to save time, reduce errors, and improve communication between departments.

Emma has now presented the solution.

David: I like the solution, but I have a concern about the price.

Emma: I understand your concern. Could you tell me a little more about it?

David: Your professional package is more expensive than another solution we've been looking at.

Emma: I see. Is the main concern the total cost, or are you comparing the features with the other solution?

David: Mainly the total cost. We have a limited budget.

Emma: That's understandable. One thing to consider is the amount of time your team could save by using the automated features.

David: How much time could we actually save?

Emma: Based on what you told me during our discovery call, your employees currently spend several hours each week entering information manually. Our platform can automate part of this process.

David: That's true. But we still need to stay within our budget.

Emma: Of course. We have another package with fewer features and a lower price. It may be a better fit for your current situation.

David: What features does it include?

Emma: It includes the shared dashboard and basic integration. It doesn't include some of the advanced reporting features.

David: That could be an option.

Emma: Great. Would you like me to send you a comparison of the two packages?

David: Yes, that would be helpful. Then I can discuss it with our Finance Director.

Emma: Absolutely. I'll send it this afternoon. Would it make sense to have another call on Friday?

David: Yes, Friday works for me.

9. Reading Comprehension

Answer the questions.

What is David's main objection?

What other solution is he considering?

What is his main concern?

What does Emma do before responding to the objection?

What benefit does Emma explain?

Why is the benefit relevant to David's company?

What alternative does Emma offer?

What is different about the alternative package?

Who does David want to discuss the solution with?

What is the next step?

10. Vocabulary in Context

Find expressions in the dialogue that the salesperson uses to:

Acknowledge the customer's concern.

> _____

Ask the customer for more information.

> _____

Clarify the objection.

> _____

Introduce a possible benefit.

> _____

Offer another option.

> _____

Check whether the option is acceptable.

> _____

Suggest a next step.

> _____

11. Objection > Response

Match each objection with the best response.

Customer objections

"It's too expensive."

"We already have a similar system."

"We're not ready to buy yet."

"I need to speak to my manager."

"I'm not sure your product is right for us."

Responses

A. "Of course. Would it make sense to arrange another call when you've discussed it?"

B. "I understand. Could you tell me what you like about your current system?"

C. "I understand. Could you tell me what you're looking for in a solution?"

D. "I understand. One thing to consider is the value it could provide over time."

E. "That's understandable. Could you tell me what makes you unsure?"

12. Speaking-Handling Objections Role-play

10-15 minutes

Situation

You are a sales representative for a technology company.

You have just presented a software solution to a potential customer.

The customer is interested, but they have an objection.

Your job is to handle the objection professionally.

Follow this structure:

STEP 1 - Acknowledge

I understand your concern.

STEP 2 - Clarify

Could you tell me more about that?

STEP 3 - Respond

Give an explanation, benefit, alternative, or solution.

STEP 4 - Check

Would that address your concern?

STEP 5 - Move forward

Suggest a next step.

12. Wrap-up & Feedback

5 minutes

The teacher gives feedback on:

Grammar accuracy

Vocabulary

Pronunciation

Fluency

Professional register